

User Guide

Find where your menu is making money, where it's leaking profit, and what deserves attention first.

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1. What this tool is (and isn't)

Menu Margin Analyzer turns the numbers you already have — selling prices, ingredient costs, and monthly sales — into a clear read on where your menu is doing well and where it's leaking profit.

It is **not** point-of-sale software, stock management, supplier management, payroll, scheduling, accounting, or an ERP system. It doesn't connect to anything and doesn't need to — you type in the numbers, and it does the interpretation.

2. Installing and opening the app

1. Download and unzip the product file.
2. Open the **app** folder.
3. Double-click **index.html**. It opens directly in your default browser.
4. That's it — no accounts, no installation, no internet connection needed after download.

index.html is a single, self-contained file — its styling and functionality are built in, so you can copy or move just that one file anywhere (a desktop shortcut, a USB drive, a shared folder) and it will keep working on its own. The style.css and app.js files are also included in the **app** folder purely for reference, in case you want to inspect or customise the underlying code — index.html does not depend on them to run.

One thing to avoid: don't open index.html directly from inside a zip preview window (e.g. double-clicking a file while still browsing inside the .zip in Windows Explorer). Some file managers create a broken temporary copy in that case. Always fully extract the zip to a folder first, then open index.html from that extracted folder.

3. The four screens

The tabs at the top of the app switch between four screens:

Menu	Add, edit, confirm, and remove dishes. This is where you enter your data.
Summary	Totals for revenue, ingredient cost, and gross profit, plus your menu benchmarks and the single biggest opportunity on your menu.
Profit Map	A visual scatter chart plotting every confirmed dish by relative sales and margin.
Opportunities	A ranked list of every dish running a higher food cost than your menu average, with the pound value of bringing it in line.

When you print a report, all four screens are included regardless of which tab is open at the time — see section 12.

4. Draft dishes vs. confirmed dishes

Every new dish starts as a **draft**. Drafts can be edited freely and are excluded from every calculation on the Summary, Profit Map, and Opportunities screens — they won't skew your averages while you're still typing in numbers.

When a dish's details are correct, click **Confirm dish**. It becomes a **confirmed** dish: it now counts toward your benchmarks, categories, and opportunities.

To change a confirmed dish, click **Edit**, make your changes, then click **Confirm changes**. Your changes stay pending until you confirm them — this stops half-finished edits from temporarily distorting your analysis.

5. How the numbers are calculated

Each dish needs four inputs: name, selling price, ingredient cost, and units sold (per month). Everything else is calculated from those four numbers.

Revenue

$$\text{Selling Price} \times \text{Units Sold}$$

Ingredient Spend

$$\text{Ingredient Cost} \times \text{Units Sold}$$

Gross Profit (per sale)

$$\text{Selling Price} - \text{Ingredient Cost}$$

Food Cost %

$$(\text{Ingredient Cost} \div \text{Selling Price}) \times 100$$

Gross Margin %

$$(\text{Gross Profit} \div \text{Selling Price}) \times 100$$

Total Gross Profit

$$\text{Gross Profit} \times \text{Units Sold}$$

6. Menu benchmarks

Once you have two or more confirmed dishes, the app calculates menu-wide benchmarks on the Summary screen:

- Average units sold
- Average gross margin

- Average gross profit per sale
- Average total profit per dish
- Overall food cost (across the whole menu)
- Overall gross margin (across the whole menu)

Every confirmed dish is then measured against these benchmarks — that's what powers the categories, the Profit Map, and the Opportunity Engine.

7. Dish categories: Strong, Grow, Optimise, Review

Each confirmed dish is placed into one of four categories by comparing its sales and margin to the menu average:

STRONG	High sales, high margin. Protect these dishes — maintain quality, keep them visible, and don't let quality slip.
GROW	Low sales, high margin. These deserve more attention — better placement, staff recommendation, promotion.
OPTIMISE	High sales, lower margin. Demand exists but the economics can improve — consider price, recipe, supplier, or portion changes.
REVIEW	Low sales, low margin. Investigate — improve it, replace it, or remove it from the menu.

A category only appears once you have at least two confirmed dishes to compare against.

8. The Profit Map

The Profit Map plots every confirmed dish on a chart: margin along the horizontal axis, sales along the vertical axis. Each dish appears as a dot, coloured by its category, in the quadrant that matches its performance. Hover over any dot to see the dish name.

This is a supporting visual — the underlying data is the same categorisation described in section 7.

9. The Opportunity Engine

For every confirmed dish whose food cost is running above your overall menu food cost, the app calculates what would happen if that dish's ingredient cost were brought in line with your menu average instead:

$$\text{Monthly improvement} = (\text{Ingredient Cost} - \text{Benchmark Ingredient Cost}) \times \text{Units Sold}$$

Dishes are ranked by the size of that monthly improvement, both on the Opportunities screen and in the “Biggest Opportunity” panel on the Summary screen.

This is deliberately phrased as a **potential** improvement, not a guaranteed one. It models what closing the gap to your own average would be worth — it isn't a prediction of what will actually happen if you change a recipe or a supplier.

10. What-if scenarios

On any confirmed dish, click **Test scenarios** to model three kinds of changes before you make them:

- **Price scenario** — test a different selling price and see the projected monthly and annual impact.
- **Cost scenario** — test a different ingredient cost (e.g. a new supplier quote or recipe change).
- **Sales scenario** — test a different monthly sales volume.

Each scenario updates live as you type and shows both the monthly and annualised (×12) effect. Nothing here changes your actual dish data — it's a sandbox for testing ideas.

11. Importing and exporting CSV

Export: click **Export CSV** on the Menu screen to download all your confirmed dishes as a CSV file, in this format:

Dish, Selling Price, Ingredient Cost, Units Sold

Import: click **Import CSV** and choose a file in the same format. Imported rows are added as confirmed dishes alongside anything already on your menu. A header row is fine — it's detected automatically and skipped. Rows that are missing required fields, or that fail validation (e.g. a negative price), are skipped rather than imported incorrectly. Imports are capped at 500 rows per file — split larger menus across more than one file.

A ready-to-use example — the same six dishes shown when you first open the app — is included as **Sample Menu.csv** in this folder.

12. Printing a report

Click **Print report** on the Summary screen (or use your browser's print function) to produce a clean, printable version of your menu covering all four screens — Menu, Summary, Profit Map, and Opportunities — regardless of which tab was open when you printed. Draft dishes and on-screen controls are hidden automatically from the printed version.

13. Your data and privacy

Everything you enter is stored locally in your browser's storage, on your own device. Nothing is sent to a server, and the app works with no internet connection after you've downloaded it. If you switch browsers or devices, or clear your browser data, export a CSV backup first — local storage doesn't travel with you.

14. Troubleshooting

The page looks unstyled, or buttons don't do anything.

This almost always means index.html was opened before the zip was fully extracted — for example, double-clicking it from inside a zip preview window rather than from an extracted folder. Extract the whole zip to a folder first (right-click → Extract All, or your OS equivalent), then open index.html from that folder. index.html is self-contained, so once it's properly extracted this won't happen.

My menu disappeared.

Local storage is tied to a specific browser on a specific device. If you opened the app in a different browser, in a private/incognito window, or cleared your browsing data, your saved menu won't be there. Re-import your last CSV export if you have one.

A dish won't confirm.

Check the error message on the dish card — usually a missing name, or a price/cost/units field that's blank, negative, or (for units sold) not a whole number.

No categories or opportunities are showing.

You need at least two confirmed dishes before categories and the Profit Map appear, and at least one dish above your average food cost before an opportunity appears.

My CSV won't import.

Confirm the file has four columns in the order Dish, Selling Price, Ingredient Cost, Units Sold, and that price/cost/units are plain numbers without currency symbols.